NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

CODE OF CONDUCT

Standards of integrity, professionalism, respect, and responsible business behaviour

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Document Type	POLICY
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Effective Date	04 November 2026
Policy Owner	People & Culture Department
Applies To	All employees of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Review Cycle	Annually, or when business/legal requirements change

Fictional demonstration policy for the OnBoardIQ environment. This document is a sample internal standard, not legal advice. It should be reviewed and approved by the company before real-world adoption.

1. Purpose

The Code of Conduct defines the ethical, professional, and behavioural standards expected of everyone working at Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It supports a workplace where people can collaborate safely, customers can trust our work, and business decisions are made responsibly.

2. Scope and application

This policy applies to all employees, including full-time, part-time, temporary, and fixed-term employees. Where relevant, employees are expected to follow these standards when working remotely, visiting customer or vendor premises, attending work-related events, or representing the company online. Contractors, consultants, interns, and vendors must follow the standards incorporated into their agreements or communicated for their engagement.

3. Core principles

- **Integrity:** Be honest, accurate, and transparent. Do not mislead colleagues, customers, suppliers, or regulators.
- **Respect:** Treat people with dignity, listen to different viewpoints, and communicate professionally.
- **Accountability:** Take responsibility for decisions, commitments, mistakes, and the quality of your work.
- **Fairness:** Make work-related decisions on relevant facts and objective criteria, without favouritism or discrimination.
- **Confidentiality:** Protect company, customer, employee, and partner information.
- **Compliance:** Follow applicable laws, contractual obligations, and approved company policies.

4. Professional behaviour

Employees must act professionally in person, in writing, in meetings, and through digital communication. Expected behaviour includes:

- Communicating clearly, respectfully, and constructively, including during disagreement.
- Being punctual and prepared for meetings and work commitments.
- Providing accurate progress updates and raising risks or blockers early.
- Using company time, systems, funds, and resources responsibly.
- Giving appropriate credit for others' contributions and respecting intellectual property.
- Avoiding conduct that damages trust, disrupts work, or creates an unsafe environment.

5. Equal opportunity, harassment, and discrimination

Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. aims to maintain a workplace free from discrimination, harassment, bullying, intimidation, and retaliation. Decisions about hiring, assignments, development, pay, and promotion should be based on role-related qualifications, performance, business needs, and applicable law.

Unacceptable conduct includes unwelcome sexual conduct, offensive comments, threats, repeated humiliation, discriminatory remarks, unwanted physical contact, and misuse of authority. Employees who experience or witness such conduct should raise a concern through People & Culture, the designated internal complaints channel, or another appropriate reporting route. Reports will be handled sensitively, fairly, and as confidentially as reasonably possible. Statutory complaint mechanisms and legal rights remain unaffected.

6. Conflicts of interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal, financial, family, or outside business interests could improperly influence—or appear to influence—their decisions for the company. Disclose actual, potential, or perceived conflicts promptly to the manager and People & Culture. Examples include:

- Having a financial interest in a supplier, customer, or competitor where it may affect company decisions.
- Taking outside employment, consulting, or directorships that conflict with work duties or company interests.
- Participating in hiring, performance, purchasing, or reporting decisions involving close relatives or personal relationships.
- Using company opportunities, information, or property for personal gain.

Employees must not make the decision themselves that a conflict is harmless. The company will review the disclosure and may document safeguards, change responsibilities, or approve the arrangement with conditions.

7. Gifts, hospitality, and anti-bribery

Employees must never offer, request, give, or accept bribes, kickbacks, facilitation payments, or anything of value intended to improperly influence a business decision. Gifts and hospitality must be modest, infrequent, transparent, lawful, and consistent with company approval requirements. Cash and cash equivalents must not be accepted. When uncertain, decline politely and seek guidance from the manager or People & Culture before proceeding.

8. Customer, supplier, and partner relationships

Employees must deal honestly and fairly with customers, suppliers, business partners, and competitors. Do not make misleading claims, misuse another party's confidential information, coordinate unlawfully with competitors, or promise products, services, discounts, or delivery dates without authority. Procurement and vendor selection must follow approved processes and be based on legitimate business criteria.

9. Confidentiality and information security

Employees must access and use company or third-party information only when authorized and for legitimate business purposes. Protect credentials, devices, documents, source code, customer data, employee records, financial information, and internal plans. Do not share confidential information with unauthorized people or upload it to unapproved services, including public AI tools. Follow the Information Security Policy, data classification rules, access controls, and incident-reporting procedures.

10. Responsible use of company assets and technology

Company equipment, software, accounts, networks, subscriptions, and funds must be used lawfully, safely, and primarily for authorized business purposes. Employees must not:

- Install unapproved or pirated software, bypass security controls, or share licensed accounts.
- Access, copy, alter, or delete information without business authorization.
- Use company systems to create, store, or distribute unlawful, harassing, discriminatory, or offensive material.
- Use company assets for fraud, personal commercial activity, or other improper purposes.
- Disable endpoint protection, share passwords, or ignore security warnings.

11. Accurate records and responsible communication

Business records, timesheets, expenses, approvals, customer communications, and project reports must be complete and accurate. Employees must not falsify, conceal, destroy, or improperly alter records. External statements, press comments, public announcements, and commitments on behalf of the company may be made only by authorized representatives.

12. Health, safety, and substance use

Employees must follow workplace safety instructions, report hazards and incidents, and behave responsibly at company premises and work-related events. Working while impaired in a way that creates a safety or performance risk is prohibited. The possession, use, or distribution of illegal drugs on company premises or during company work is prohibited. Any alcohol-related activity at an approved company event must comply with law and company instructions.

13. Social media and public representation

Employees should make clear when they are expressing personal views rather than speaking for Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Do not disclose confidential information, publish customer or colleague information without authorization, impersonate the company, or make misleading statements on its behalf. Online conduct connected to work must remain respectful and comply with confidentiality and anti-harassment standards.

14. Reporting concerns and non-retaliation

Employees are encouraged to report suspected misconduct, fraud, bribery, harassment, discrimination, safety risks, data incidents, or violations of this Code. Reports may be made to the reporting manager, People & Culture, the Security team, or the designated reporting channel, depending on the issue. If the concern involves the manager, use another reporting route.

Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith, asks for guidance, or participates in an investigation is prohibited. Reports will be reviewed fairly, and information will be shared only with those who need it to assess or address the matter. Knowingly false or malicious allegations may be addressed through the appropriate process.

15. Investigations and consequences

Employees are expected to cooperate honestly with authorized investigations and preserve relevant information. Where a breach is substantiated, the company may take proportionate corrective or disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, subject to applicable law and employment terms. Serious matters may also be referred to appropriate authorities where required.

16. Roles and responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Every employee	Understand and follow the Code; complete required training; raise concerns promptly.
Managers	Model expected conduct; respond to concerns; prevent retaliation; escalate issues appropriately.
People & Culture	Maintain the policy; advise employees; coordinate fair handling of workplace concerns.
IT / Security	Guide secure use of systems and respond to reported technology or information-security incidents.
Leadership	Set expectations, support consistent enforcement, and provide appropriate resources.

17. Questions, exceptions, and policy review

Questions about this Code should be directed to the People & Culture Department at people@northstar.example. Exceptions require prior written approval from an authorized company representative and must not conflict with applicable law. The People & Culture Department owns this policy and will review it at least annually or when business or legal requirements change. The latest approved version will be made available through the company document repository.

Employee acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received and read the Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Code of Conduct (HR-POL-003, Version 1.0). I understand that I am expected to follow these standards, complete required training, and raise concerns in good faith when I become aware of possible misconduct.

Employee name: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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